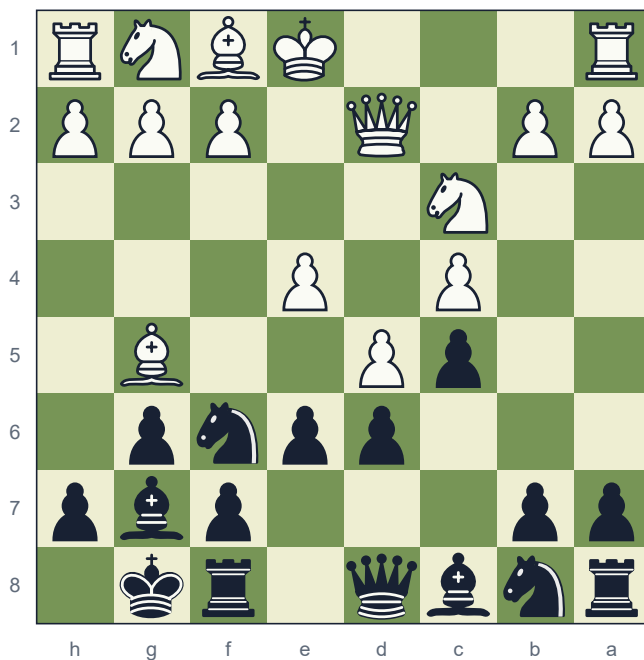


Early bishops and unusual central systems

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Bg5 O-O 6. Qd2 c5 7. d5 e6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Distinguish early Bg5, Be3, Bd3, Nge2 and h4. Use a sound central challenge and develop against the actual threat. White has not promised to enter the Classical.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White often keeps the broad d4/e4 center but changes a bishop square or the g1 knight route. That can alter pins and the safety of ...e5.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Check the bishop's full diagonal.
2. Ask whether e4 is protected tactically.
3. Do not punish an unusual move without calculation.

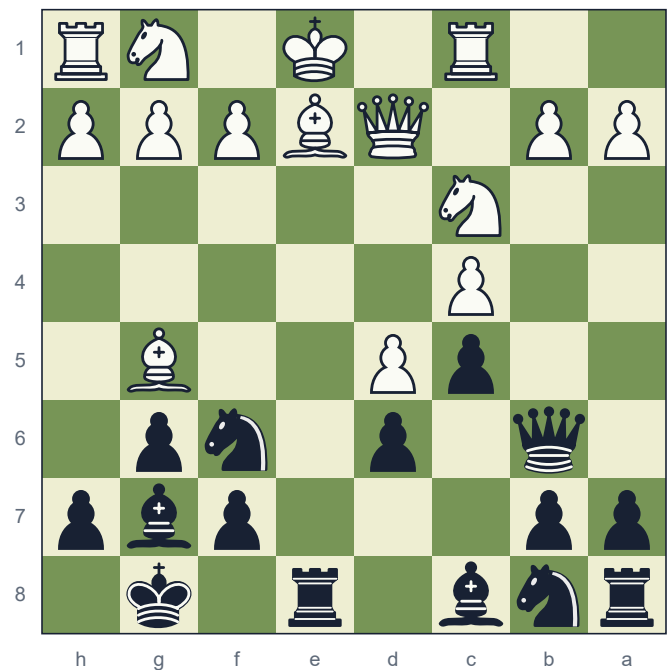
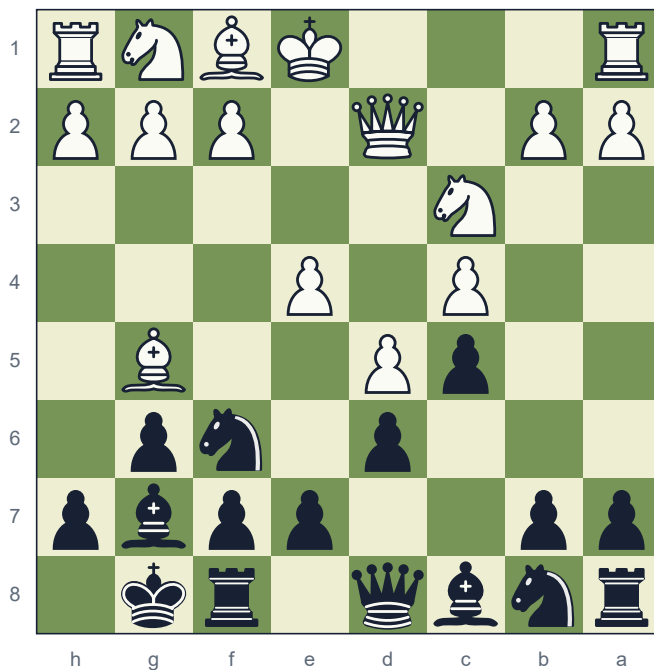
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Accelerated Averbakh: 5.Bg5

STUDY LINE 16-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Bg5 O-O 6. Qd2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Be2 exd5 9. exd5 Qb6 10. Rc1 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 7... e6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White develops the bishop before Be2. ...c5 and ...e6 question the center while the king knight is still on g1.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop against the resulting pawn structure. Be alert to Bh6 and to the queen's role in supporting d4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A queen on d2 is not the same defender as a knight on f3. Check recaptures instead of forcing a familiar line.

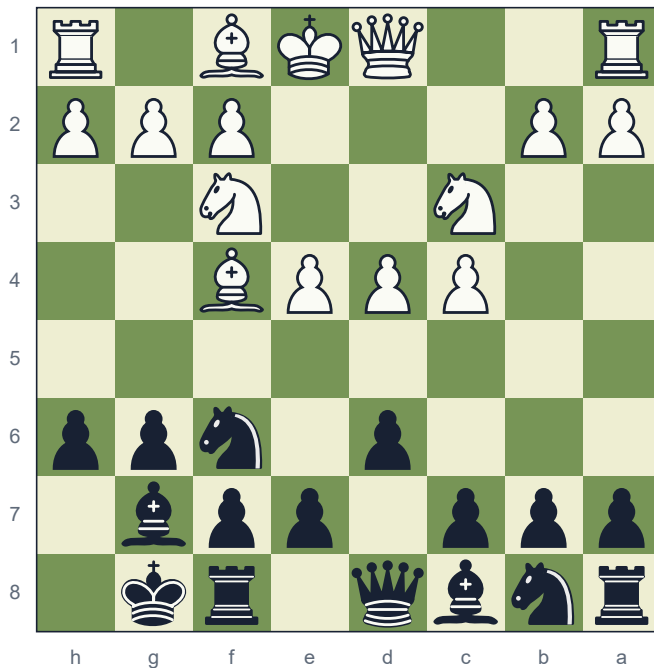
REMEMBER Early bishop development changes the tactical support.

02 Zinnowitz: Nf3 and Bg5

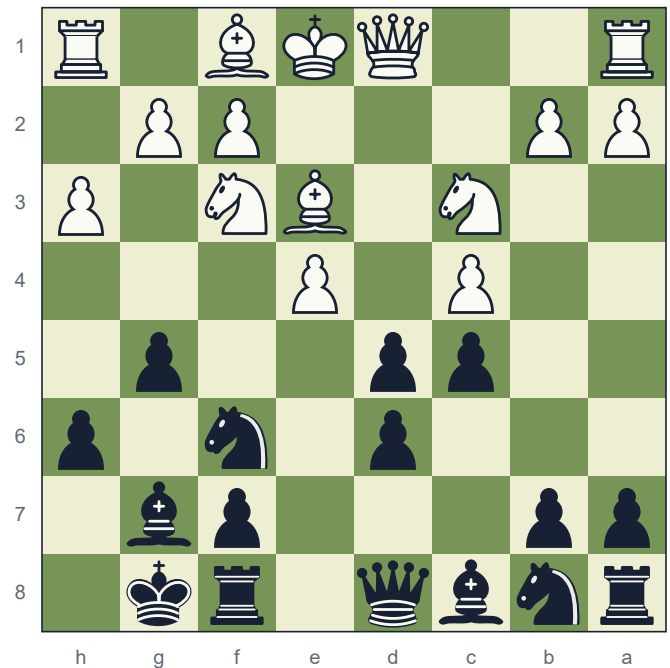
STUDY LINE 16-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bf4 c5 8. d5 g5 9. Be3 e6 10. h3 exd5

Selected anchor ends with 7... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...h6 questions the bishop; after Bf4, ...c5 challenges d4. White has developed actively without choosing Be2.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use central exchanges to activate pieces. Keep d6 defended against the bishop on f4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The f4 bishop attacks d6. Moving Nf6 or the queen can change whether that pawn can be captured.

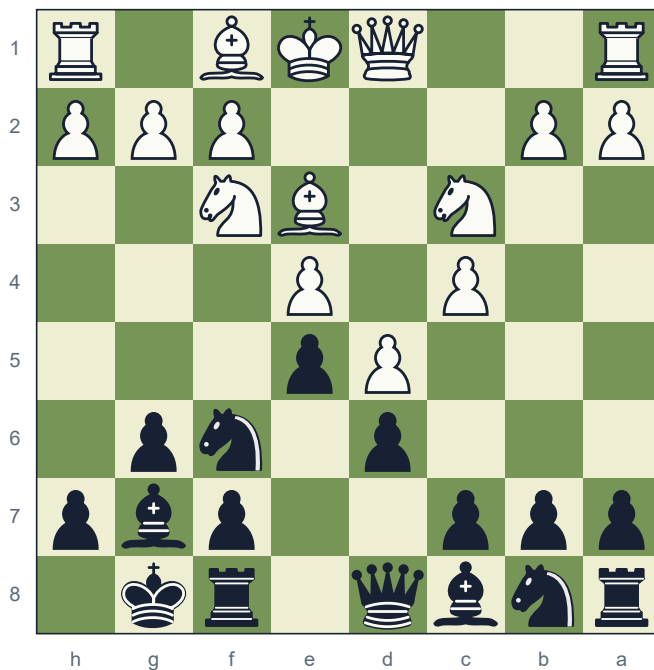
REMEMBER An active bishop creates a real target.

03 Larsen system: Nf3 and Be3

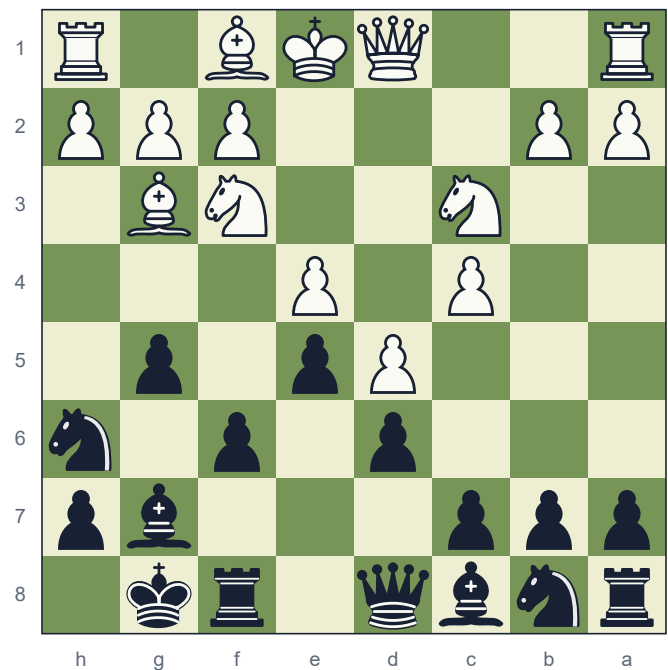
STUDY LINE 16-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be3 e5 7. d5 Ng4 8. Bg5 f6 9. Bh4 g5 10. Bg3 Nh6

Selected anchor ends with 7... Ng4. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black contests d4 with ...e5. After d5, ...Ng4 questions the bishop before White gets a comfortable closed center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the b8 knight and complete a coordinated plan. If the bishop retreats, improve the knight rather than leaving it exposed.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White has not spent a tempo on Be2. The extra flexibility can matter in a kingside attack.

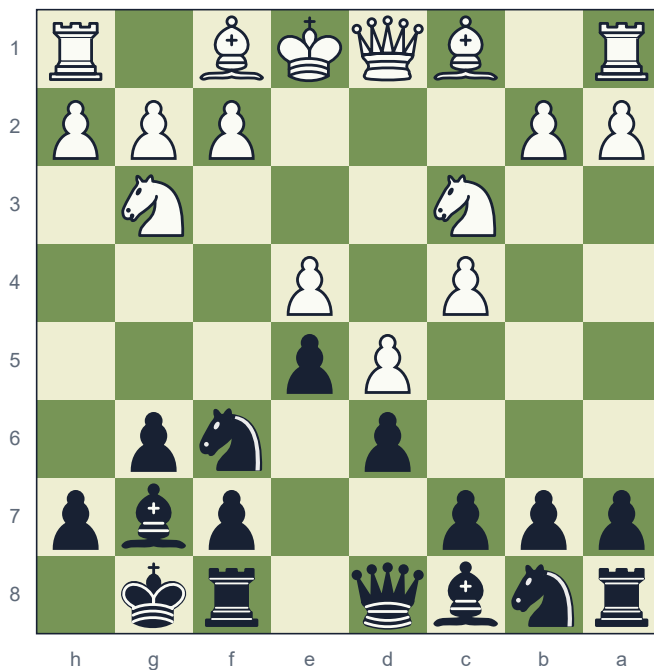
REMEMBER Gain a useful tempo, then develop.

04 Kramer system: 5.Nge2

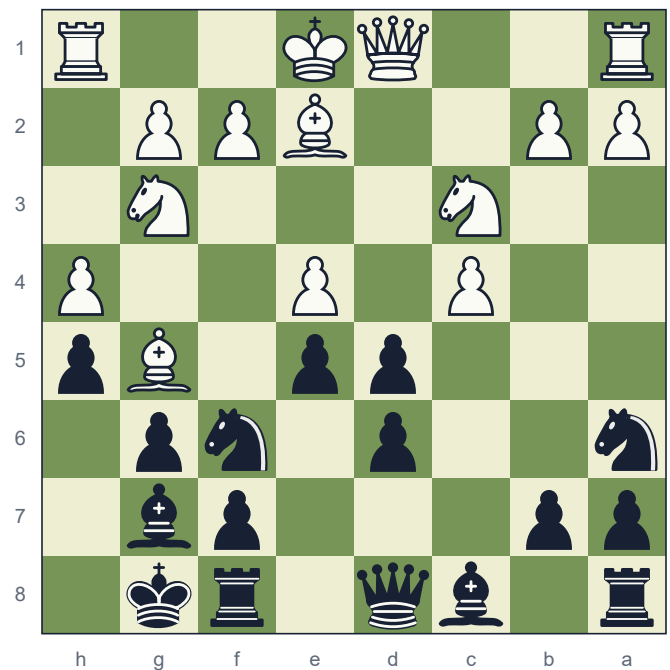
STUDY LINE 16-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nge2 O-O 6. Ng3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. h4 h5 9. Bg5 c6 10. Be2 cxd5

Selected anchor ends with 7... Na6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White sends the knight toward g3 to support e4 and future kingside play. Black closes the center only after challenging it and develops toward c5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Watch f4 and h4. Use ...Nc5, ...c6 or a prepared ...f5 according to White's king choice.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The knight on g3 controls f5 and h5. A standard pawn attack may run into additional defenders.

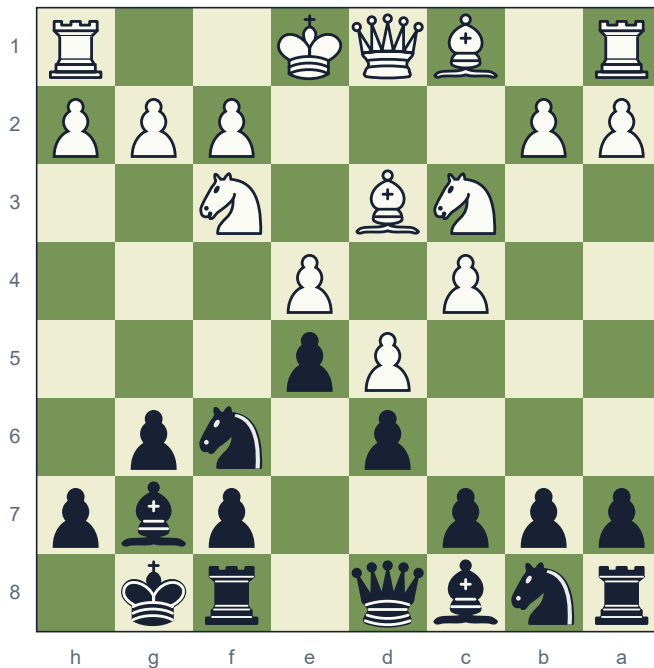
REMEMBER Count the new defenders on the kingside.

05 Bd3: protect e4 with the bishop

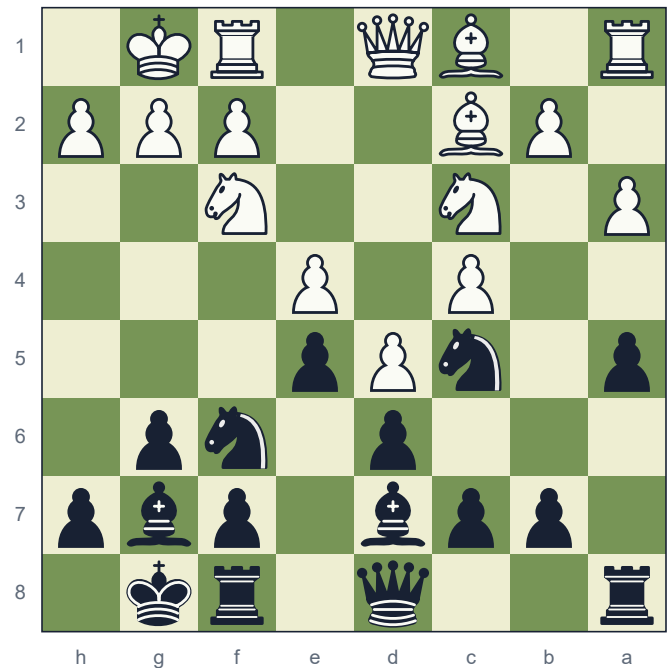
STUDY LINE 16-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Bd3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. a3 Nc5 9. Bc2 a5 10. O-O Bd7

Selected anchor ends with 7... Na6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Bd3 supports e4 but can become a target after central pawn advances. Black develops the queenside knight toward c5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Improve the c8 bishop and keep ...Nc5 or ...Nh5 ideas in mind when they gain time on a bishop.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A bishop on d3 can point at h7 after the center opens. Do not open lines around your king carelessly.

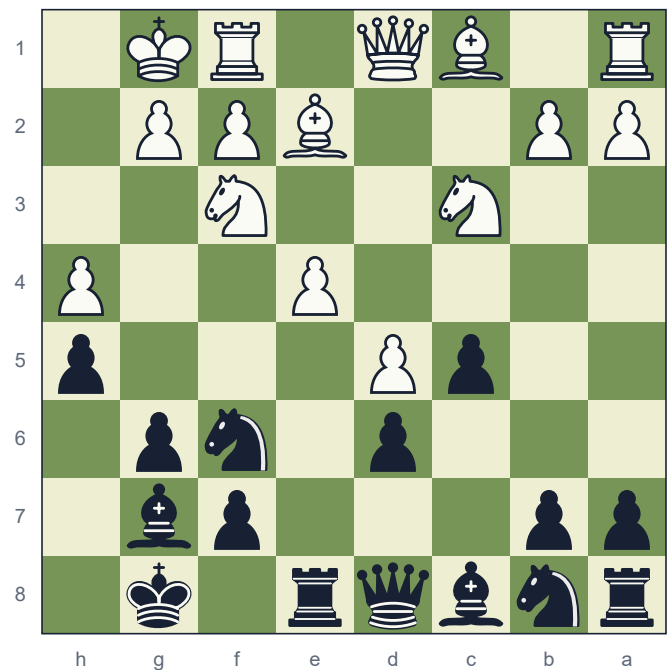
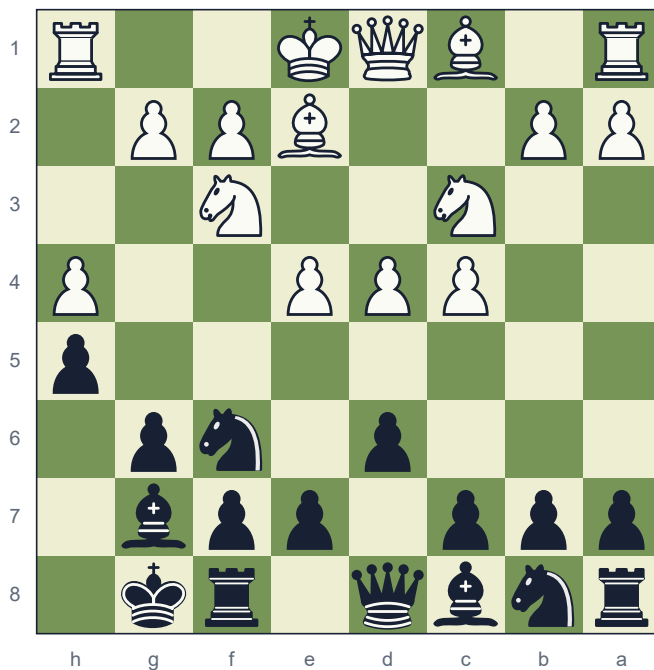
REMEMBER Bishop placement matters when pawn lines open.

06 An early h4 before development

STUDY LINE 16-06

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h4 h5 6. Nf3 O-O 7. Be2 c5 8. d5 e6 9. O-O exd5 10. cxd5 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 7... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...h5 blocks the immediate h4-h5 lever. Black then develops and challenges d4 rather than answering every pawn move with another pawn.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Meet g4 as a new concrete threat. Decide central captures by piece activity and king safety.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The h5 pawn can be undermined by g4. It is a restraint and a target at the same time.

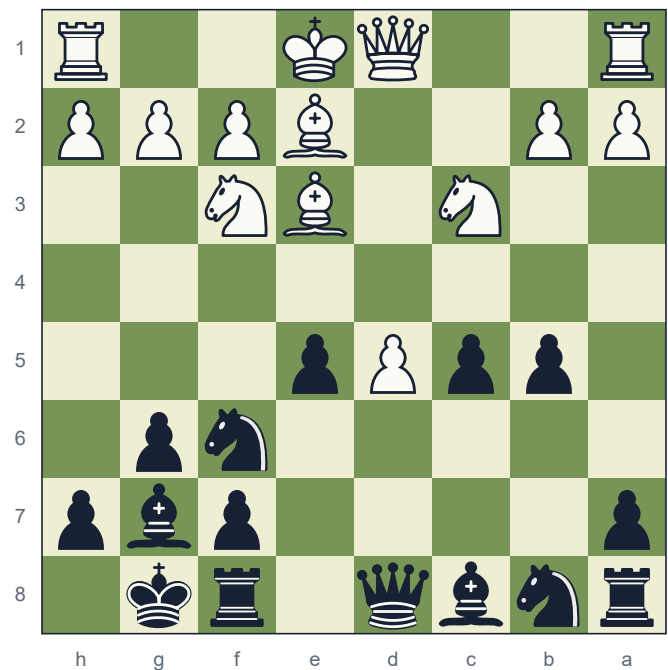
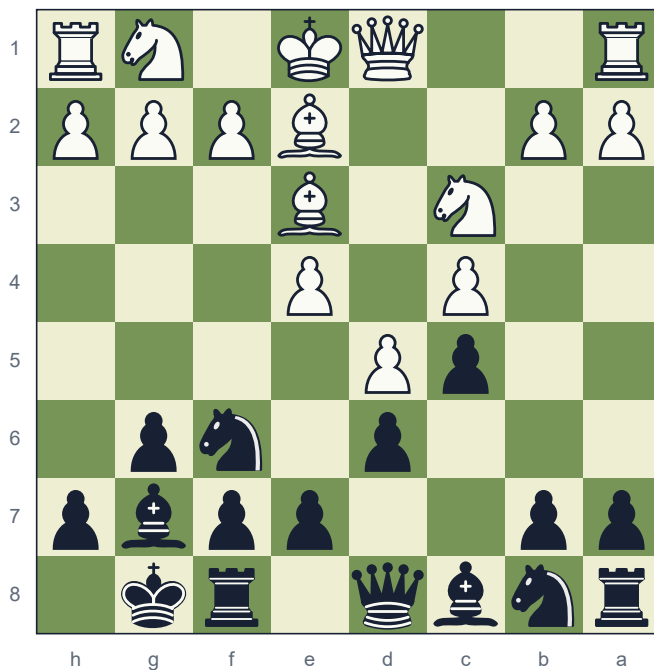
REMEMBER Block a lever, then fight for the center.

07 Semi-Averbakh: Be2 and Be3 without Nf3

STUDY LINE 16-07

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Be3 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Nf3 exd5 9. cxd5 b5 10. e5 dxe5

Selected anchor ends with 7... e6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White develops both bishops while keeping the g1 knight flexible. ...c5 and ...e6 challenge the center before White can choose a comfortable attacking formation.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Compare recaptures on d5 and develop against the resulting Benoni structure. White may choose Nf3, Nge2, f3 or f4, so keep those changes separate.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

This is not the Gligoric position: White has not put the knight on f3. Do not import its ...Ng4 sequence automatically.

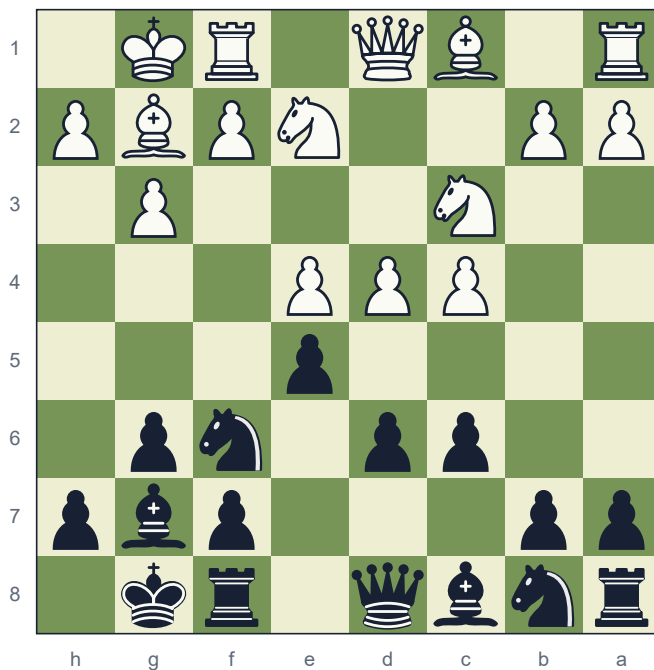
REMEMBER An undeveloped knight can preserve several different plans.

08 Delayed Fianchetto with Nge2

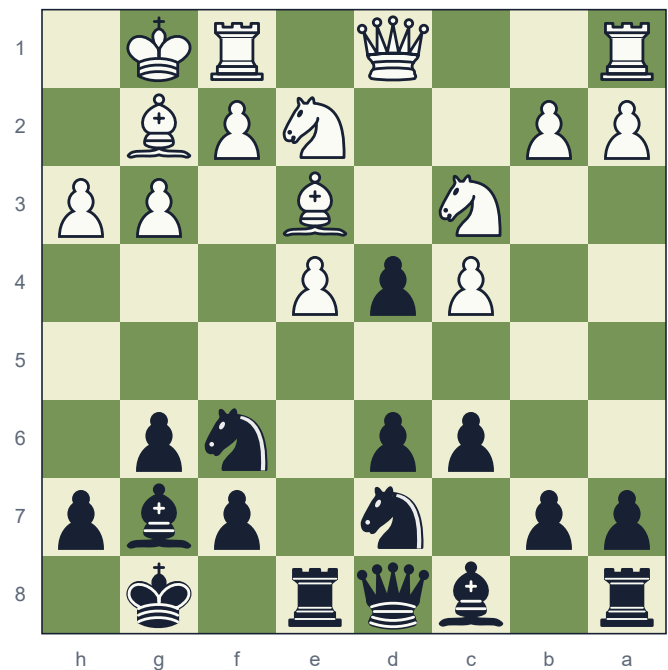
STUDY LINE 16-08

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 e5 7. Nge2 c6 8. O-O Nbd7 9. h3 Re8 10. Be3 exd4

Selected anchor ends with 8... Nbd7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White combines the broad e4 center with a fianchetto and develops the king knight to e2. Black reinforces the center with ...c6 and ...Nbd7.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...Re8 and compare ...exd4 or a supported ...d5. White may play f4 more easily because Nf3 is absent.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The knight on e2 does not defend e5 and g5 like Nf3, but it leaves the f-pawn free. Recalculate any central advance or kingside break.

REMEMBER A different knight route changes the pawn-break timing.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White often keeps the broad d4/e4 center but changes a bishop square or the g1 knight route. That can alter pins and the safety of ...e5.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop against the resulting pawn structure. Be alert to Bh6 and to the queen's role in supporting d4.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.